

Activity 8 Decompose Scope into a WBS and WBS Dictionary with GenAI

Activity 8 | Topic 01 | C013 | Version v1.0

Course: Generative AI for Project Management (C013) Topic 01: Project Initiation and Planning with GenAI Learning outcome: LO1 - Decompose project scope into work packages with a supporting dictionary. Tools: GenAI tool | WBS Template.pptx | WBS Dictionary.xlsx

Goal

The WBS is the backbone of the plan - everything downstream, schedule and cost, is built from it. GenAI decomposes work quickly; your job is to check the decomposition is complete and mutually exclusive.

What you'll produce

A three-level WBS and a WBS Dictionary for your work packages.

Activity files

- [Activity guide PDF](./activity-guide.pdf)
- [Prompt sheet](./prompts.pdf)
- [Detailed instruction manual](./instruction-manual.pdf)
- [Mock data workbook](./mock-data.xlsx)

Core prompt

Create a three-level work breakdown structure for implementing an internal knowledge portal for a consulting firm.

Step-by-step

1. In your group, prompt GenAI: 'Create a WBS for implementing an internal knowledge portal for a consulting firm.' - or use your own project scenario.
2. Organise the output into levels 1, 2 and 3 in 'WBS Template.pptx'. Level 3 items should be work packages - small enough to assign to one person or team.
3. Apply the 100% rule: the children of any node must add up to all of that node's work, with no overlap. Ask GenAI: 'Does this WBS satisfy the 100% rule? Identify any missing or overlapping work.'
4. Check for the work GenAI habitually forgets: project management effort itself, testing, training, documentation, handover and warranty support. Add what is missing.
5. Open 'WBS Dictionary.xlsx'. Prompt GenAI: 'For each work package, produce a WBS dictionary entry with WBS code, description of work, responsible role, resources required, cost estimate, quality requirements and acceptance criteria.'
6. Review each entry - particularly the acceptance criteria, which must be testable. Rewrite any that are vague ('works well' is not an acceptance criterion).
7. Confirm the flow is intact: Scope Statement → WBS → Work Packages → Activity List, ready for scheduling. Share with the class.

Check your work

Check: Your WBS decomposes to assignable work packages, satisfies the 100% rule, includes PM/testing/training effort, and every dictionary entry has testable acceptance criteria.

Remember: GenAI gives you a fast first draft. Check every figure, source and assumption before the output leaves your hands - you remain accountable for it.

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